# SENTENCE STRUCTURES

1. Simple sentence ( câu đơn)

| S + V + O |
|---|

Ex : I like reading comic books.

Ex: I take my kids to go to school every day.

| S + V + DIRECT OBJECT + pre + INDIRECT OBJECT |
|---|
| |

Ex: My father always gives a present for me on my birthday.

S V D.O Pre I.O

| S + V + INDIRECT OBJECT + DIRECT OBJECT |
|---|

Ex: My father always gives **me** a present on my birthday.

S V I.O D.O

2. Compound sentence (câu kép)

| S + V + and/ but/ so + S + V |
|---|

Ex: I like listening to music, but I don't like playing sports.
Ex: She is well- qualified and she is very professional.
Ex: We are very tired, so we cannot continue working.

3. Complex sentence ( câu phức)

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|---|---|
| Main clause<br>( mệnh đề chính) | Subordinate clause ( mệnh đề phụ) |
| | Adjective clauses ( who/ whom, which, whose ,that) |
| | If clause ( loai 2 ) |
| | Time clause ( as soon as/when / until /before /after ) |
| | Clause of reason ( because, since) |
| | Clause of contrast ( even though, although, though) |

Adjective clause

Ex: The man who/that is standing at the counter is a headmaster.

I was born in HCM city which/that is located in the south of Vietnam.
Ex: The woman whose daughter won the beauty contest is very generous.

If clause (type 2)

| If clause | Result clause ( main clause) |
|---|---|
| Simple past | would + V1 |

Ex: If I won the lottery, I would spend my money building a new house.

Time clause

| Main Clause | Time clause ( when / as soon as / before/ until/ after) |
|---|---|
| Simple future | Simple present |

Ex: When I pass the VSTEP examination, I will take a short holiday.
I will take a short holiday when I pass the VSTEP examination

Ex: After you come to HCM city, I will show you around.

**Clause of reason**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| S+ V …… + | because | + S + | V | |

Ex: I like playing sports because it helps me to keep fit.
Ex: Because the rain was heavy, some students couldn't go to class yesterday.

**Clause of contrast**

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| S + V + | although/even though / though | + | S + V | |

Ex: They didn't control the situation although the government helped them a lot.
Although the government helped them a lot, they didn't control the situation.
The government helped them a lot, but they didn't control the situation.
Although the flood was terrible, people were trying to overcome its damage.

**Sentence patterns**

1

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|---|---|
| Not only +V/ N/ Adj/ Adv…….. | but also + V / N /ADJ/ Adv …… |

Ex: He is not only handsome but also rich.
Ex: He not only studies well but also plays the guitar very beautifully.
Ex: Deforestation not only causes serious flood but also causes the soil erosion.
Ex: The amount of carbon dioxide not only contributes to the air pollution, but also leads to the greenhouse effect/ global warming.

2

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|---|
| S + TO BE + ADJ + TO INFINITIVE + THAT + CLAUSE |

Ex: I am happy to hear that you are going to visit my hometown.

3

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|---|
| S+ TO BE + ADJ + TO INFINITIVE |

I am very glad to receive your letter.

4

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|---|
| S + TO BE + ADJ + for Sb + To INFINITIVE + THAT + CLAUSE |

Ex: It is pleased for me to know that you have just got a good job.
Ex: It is necessary for city dwellers to know that they should use public transportation to travel around.

5

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|---|
| S + TO BE + ADJ + for Sb + To INFINITIVE |

Ex: It is necessary for young people to learn English.
Ex: It is necessary for flooding victims to evacuate to higher places and store dried food and water.
Ex: It is necessary for young people to do social work/ unpaid community services.

6.

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|---|
| S + TO BE + SO + ADJ + THAT + S + V |

Ex: The book is so interesting that I cannot stop reading.
I was so busy that I didn't return your book as I promised.

7.

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|---|
| S + V + that + S + V |

Ex: I realized that everybody had worked so hard to finish the project.
Ex: Every citizen should be aware that the protection of environment is their responsibility, not only the government but also local authorities.

LINKING WORDS

Honestly: thú thật
Actually: thực sự
In fact: thực tế
Typically: điển hình là...

Basically: về mặt cơ bản
Similarly: tương tự
More importantly: điều quan trọng hơn là
Additionally/ in addition:  thêm vào đó
Moreover: hơn nữa
Furthermore: hơn nữa
By contrast: ngược lại
However: tuy vậy
Nevertheless: tuy nhiên
Alternatively: có thể thay thế
For instance/for example/to illustrate/ to be specific: ví dụ
Firstly/ Secondly/Thirdly/Finally,
The first /second /third reason / advantage/ benefit/ disadvantage/ drawback/effect/ solution is that …..
To begin with/ First of all/
In addition/Moreover/ Furthermore / Also
Last but not least,
On the one hand,
On the other hand,

In conclusion,
In short,
In summary,
To conclude,
To summarize,